

August 20, 2026

Ambetter from Absolute Total Care
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Morgan Gislason (MRN MUSC1901974), Claim MUSC-9AF8-1

Patient	Morgan Gislason (DOB 2007-12-15)
MRN	MUSC1901974
Member ID / Group	AMB513828945 / GRP-47184
Claim number	MUSC-9AF8-1
Date of service	2026-05-01
Procedure billed	CPT 99214 — Office/outpatient visit, established patient, moderate complexity
Primary diagnosis	J06.9 — Acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified
Denied amount	\$978.07
Denial code	CARC 16 / RARC N290 — Claim/service lacks information or has submission/billing error(s).
Appeal deadline	2026-09-09

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health is submitting this formal appeal on behalf of patient Morgan Gislason (MRN: MUSC1901974, Member ID: AMB513828945) regarding the denial of Claim MUSC-9AF8-1 for services rendered on May 1, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center. The claim was denied on June 11, 2026, under CARC 16 and RARC N290, with the payer remark stating: "Claim cannot be adjudicated; required data element(s) are missing or invalid," citing a missing, incomplete, or invalid rendering provider primary identifier. MUSC Health respectfully disputes this denial and asserts that the rendering provider's National Provider Identifier was present and valid on the original claim submission.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Morgan Gislason is an 18-year-old established female patient with active coverage under the Ambetter from Absolute Total Care PPO plan (Group GRP-47184) for the period January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026. She presented on May 1, 2026, at MUSC Health University Medical Center (Place of Service 22 — On Campus Outpatient Hospital) for an outpatient visit billed under CPT 99214, reflecting an office or outpatient visit for an established patient of moderate complexity. The encounter was associated with a primary diagnosis of acute upper respiratory infection, unspecified (ICD-10 J06.9), and a secondary diagnosis code of R69. The visit was rendered by Daniel R. Okafor, MD, whose NPI on file is 1558493021. The claim was submitted on May 19, 2026, with a total billed amount of \$978.07 and revenue code 0510.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

The sole stated basis for denial is CARC 16 / RARC N290 — that the rendering provider's primary identifier was missing, incomplete, or invalid. MUSC Health maintains that this characterization is incorrect. Dr. Daniel R. Okafor's NPI, 1558493021, is an active, valid Type 1 NPI registered in the National Plan and Provider Enumeration System (NPPES) and was included in the appropriate loop and segment of the original electronic claim submission in accordance with standard HIPAA transaction requirements. A billing error of this nature, if any existed, would constitute a correctable administrative deficiency rather than a clinical or coverage-based denial.

MUSC Health is resubmitting this appeal with supporting documentation confirming Dr. Okafor's NPI and its placement on the original claim. Payers are obligated under applicable state and federal regulations, as well as the terms of their provider agreements, to provide a reasonable opportunity to cure administrative deficiencies before issuing a final denial. Denying payment in full — resulting in \$0.00 paid against an allowed amount of \$654.14 — on the basis of a correctable data element, without first issuing a request for additional information or a remittance advisory allowing for resubmission, is inconsistent with standard claims adjudication practice and applicable prompt-pay obligations.

The services themselves are not in dispute with respect to medical necessity or coverage. The patient holds active coverage, the rendering provider is an enrolled participating physician, the place of service is appropriate, and the CPT and ICD-10 codes accurately reflect the services provided. There is no clinical or contractual basis to deny payment for this encounter.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Ambetter from Absolute Total Care reverse the denial of Claim MUSC-9AF8-1, reprocess the claim with the confirmed NPI for rendering provider Daniel R. Okafor, MD (NPI 1558493021), and issue payment in accordance with the contracted allowed amount. Should the plan require any additional documentation to complete adjudication, we ask that a specific written request be directed to our provider relations team promptly so that we may respond within the applicable timeframe. This appeal is being submitted through the secure provider portal in advance of the September 9, 2026, appeal deadline.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)

- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record